

“Impact of Discounts and Delivery Time on Customer Preference in Food Delivery Applications”

E-Commerce and Digital Service Sector

Project Report submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of

**Bachelor of Business Administration
Specialised in Business Analytics**

Submitted By

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**Enrollment No:23GSOB1090059
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**IN
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS**

**Under The Supervision of
Mr Nakul**



(Established under Galgotias University Uttar Pradesh Act No. 14 of 2011)

MAY,2025



SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this project report, **“Impact of Discounts and Delivery Time on Customer Preference in Food Delivery Applications”**, is the bona fide work of **“KUSHAGRA TAMANG (23GSOB1090059)”** who carried out the project work under my supervision.

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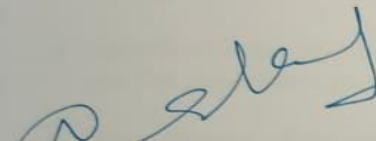
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The degree of Bachelor of Business Administration, Specialised in Business Analytics


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Place: Galgotias University

STATEMENT OF PREPARATION

- a. Thesis Title: **Impact of Discounts and Delivery Time on Customer Preference in Food Delivery Applications**, E-Commerce and Digital Service Sector
- b. Degree for which the report is submitted: **Bachelor of Business Administration (Business Analytics)**.
- c. The project supervisor was referred to for preparing the report and for guidance throughout the research work.
- d. Specifications regarding the project report format have been closely followed as per the guidelines provided by the institution.
- e. The contents of the report have been organised and prepared according to the prescribed academic structure and research methodology.
- f. The report has been prepared without resorting to plagiarism, and the work presented is original in nature.
- g. All sources of information, references, journals, websites, and research materials used in the study have been properly acknowledged and cited.
- h. The report has not been submitted previously, either fully or partially, to any other university or institution for the award of any degree, diploma, or certification.

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DECLARATION

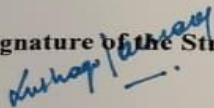
I, Kushagra Tamang, hereby declare that the project report titled:
"Impact of Discounts and Delivery Time on Customer Preference in Food Delivery Applications",
E-Commerce and Digital Service Sector.

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Business Administration (Business Analytics), is a record of original research work carried out by me under the guidance and supervision of the project supervisor.

I further declare that this project report has not been submitted previously, either fully or partially, to any other university or institution for the award of any degree, diploma, or certification.

The information and data presented in this report are true to the best of my knowledge, and all sources of information used in the study have been properly acknowledged and cited.

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ABSTRACT

The online food delivery industry has experienced rapid growth due to increasing internet usage, changing consumer lifestyles, and the growing demand for convenience-based services. Online food delivery applications such as Swiggy and Zomato have become highly popular among consumers by providing quick access to a wide range of food options along with attractive discounts and convenient delivery services. The present study focuses on analysing the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference towards online food delivery applications.

The primary objective of the study was to examine how discounts and delivery efficiency influence customer decision-making and satisfaction while selecting food delivery platforms. The research was conducted using a descriptive research design. Primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire distributed online using Google Forms. A total of 58 responses were collected from users of online food delivery applications. Secondary data was also collected from journals, websites, and online research sources related to the food delivery industry.

The findings of the study revealed that discounts and promotional offers are the most influential factors affecting customer preference towards food delivery applications. Delivery time was also identified as a significant factor influencing customer satisfaction and platform loyalty. The study further showed that many consumers are willing to switch applications for better discounts and faster delivery services. Among the surveyed respondents, Zomato emerged as the most frequently used application.

The study concludes that pricing strategies and delivery efficiency play a major role in shaping customer behaviour in the online food delivery industry. The research suggests that food delivery companies should focus on improving service quality, delivery performance, promotional strategies, and customer satisfaction in order to maintain competitiveness and strengthen customer loyalty.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER NO.	TITLE	PAGE NO.
1.	1.1 Introduction	1
	1.2 Industry Overview	2
	1.3 Company Profile of Swiggy	3
	1.4 Company Profile of Zomato	4
	1.5 Research Questions	5
	1.6 Research Objectives	6
	1.7 Hypothesis of the Study	7
2.	2.1 Literature Review	8
	2.2 Research Gap	9
3.	Research Methodology	10
4.	Data Analysis and Interpretation	11
	4.1 Age Group Respondents	
	4.2 Gender Distributions of Respondents	
	4.3 Occupation of Respondents	12
	4.4 Most Frequently Used Food Delivery Applications	
	4.5 Frequency of Ordering Food Online	13
	4.6 Monthly Spendings on Food Online	
	4.7 Factors Affecting the Choice of Food Delivery App	14
	4.8 Imp. of Discount and Promotional Offers	
	4.9 Imp. of Delivery Time	15
	4.10 Switching to Another App. for Better Discount	
	4.11 Switching to Another App. For Faster Delivery	16
	4.12 App with better Discounts and Offers	
	4.13 App with faster Delivery Services	17
	4.14 Overall Satisfaction with Food Delivery App	
	4.15 Suggestions and Feedback	18
	4.16 Correlation Analysis	19
	4.17 Weighted Average Analysis	20
	4.18 Hypothesis Evaluation	21
5.	Major Findings of The Study	22
6.	6.1 Limitations of The Study	24
	6.2 Scope for Future Research	25
7.	Conclusion	26
8.	Recommendations	27
9.	Appendix	28
10.	References	31

LIST OF TABLES

TABLE NO.	TITLE	PAGE NO.
Table 1.1	Key Information about Swiggy	3
Table 1.2	Key Information about Zomato	4
Table 4.1	Correlation Between Discounts and Customer Satisfaction	19
Table 4.2	Correlation Between Delivery Time and Customer Satisfaction	19
Table 4.3	Weighted Average Analysis of Discounts and Delivery Time	20
Table 4.4	Hypothesis Evaluation Results	21
Table 5.1	Summary of Major Findings	23
Table 7.1	Summary of Key Results	

LIST OF FIGURES

FIGURE NO.	TITLE	PAGE NO.
Figure 4.1	Age Group of Respondents	11
Figure 4.2	Gender Distribution of Respondents	11
Figure 4.3	Occupation of Respondents	12
Figure 4.4	Most Frequently Used Food Delivery Application	12
Figure 4.5	Frequency of Ordering Food Online	13
Figure 4.6	Monthly Spending on Online Food Delivery Services	13
Figure 4.7	Factors Influencing the Choice of Food Delivery Application	14
Figure 4.8	Importance of Discounts and Promotional Offers	14
Figure 4.9	Importance of Delivery Time	15
Figure 4.10	Switching to Another Application for Better Discounts	15
Figure 4.11	Switching to Another Application for Faster Delivery	16
Figure 4.12	Application Providing Better Discounts and Offers	16
Figure 4.13	Application Providing Faster Delivery Service	17
Figure 4.14	Overall Satisfaction with Online Food Delivery Services	17

CHAPTER 1

1.1 INTRODUCTION

The rapid growth of the digital economy and increasing dependence on technology have significantly transformed consumer purchasing behaviour in recent years. One of the major sectors influenced by this transformation is the online food delivery industry. With the widespread use of smartphones, improved internet accessibility, changing lifestyles, and rising demand for convenience, food delivery platforms have become an integral part of modern consumer culture. Applications such as Swiggy and Zomato have revolutionised the food service market by enabling customers to order meals quickly and conveniently from a wide range of restaurants.

The online food delivery market has become highly competitive, with companies continuously adopting innovative marketing and operational strategies to attract and retain customers. Among the various factors influencing consumer preference, discounts and delivery time play a particularly significant role in shaping purchasing decisions. Attractive promotional offers, cashback schemes, and reduced delivery charges often encourage customers to choose one platform over another. Similarly, fast and reliable delivery services enhance customer satisfaction and influence repeat usage behaviour.

In today's competitive environment, understanding customer preferences has become essential for businesses to maintain market share and improve service quality. Consumer expectations are no longer limited to product availability; customers now seek affordability, convenience, speed, and overall service efficiency. Therefore, analysing the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preferences provides valuable insights into consumer behaviour and the effectiveness of business strategies.

The primary objective of this study is to examine how discounts and delivery time influence customer decision-making while selecting food delivery applications. The study is based on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire from users of online food delivery platforms. The research aims to identify key consumer preferences, analyse behavioural patterns, and evaluate the relative importance of pricing incentives and delivery efficiency in shaping customer choices. The findings of this study may help food delivery companies improve their customer engagement strategies, enhance user satisfaction, and develop more effective competitive approaches in the growing online food delivery industry.

1.2 INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

Online Food Delivery Industry in India

The online food delivery industry has emerged as one of the fastest-growing segments of India's digital economy. The increasing adoption of smartphones, affordable internet services, digital payment systems, and changing consumer lifestyles have significantly contributed to the growth of online food delivery platforms. Consumers today prefer convenient and time-saving solutions for their daily needs, leading to a rapid increase in the demand for online food ordering services.

Online food delivery platforms act as intermediaries between restaurants and customers by providing a digital platform through which users can browse menus, place orders, make online payments, and track deliveries in real time. These platforms have transformed traditional food ordering methods by offering convenience, accessibility, and a wide variety of food options at customers' fingertips.

The Indian online food delivery market has witnessed substantial growth over the past decade. Urbanisation, busy work schedules, increasing disposable income, and the growing preference for convenience-based services have encouraged consumers to use food delivery applications more frequently. The COVID-19 pandemic further accelerated the adoption of online food delivery services as consumers increasingly relied on digital platforms for contactless ordering and delivery.

Among the leading players in the Indian food delivery market, Swiggy and Zomato have established a dominant presence. These companies continuously compete by offering discounts, promotional campaigns, loyalty programs, improved user experience, and faster delivery services. Their competitive strategies have significantly influenced customer expectations and purchasing behaviour.

The industry operates through a platform-based business model involving four key stakeholders: customers, restaurants, delivery partners, and the platform provider. Customers place orders through the application, restaurants prepare the food, delivery partners ensure timely delivery, and the platform manages the entire ordering and payment process. The efficiency of coordination among these stakeholders directly impacts customer satisfaction and service quality.

Customer expectations in the online food delivery industry have evolved considerably. Consumers not only seek a wide variety of food choices but also expect affordable pricing, attractive discounts, accurate order tracking, quick delivery, secure payment options, and responsive customer support. As a result, companies continuously invest in technology, logistics infrastructure, and marketing strategies to maintain a competitive advantage.

The future of the online food delivery industry appears highly promising due to continuous technological advancements, increasing internet penetration, expansion into smaller cities, and changing consumer behaviour. The growing emphasis on customer experience, personalised recommendations, subscription programs, and sustainable delivery practices is expected to further drive industry growth in the coming years.

Therefore, understanding the factors that influence customer preference, particularly discounts and delivery efficiency, is important for food delivery companies seeking to improve customer satisfaction, strengthen customer loyalty, and maintain long-term competitiveness in the rapidly evolving digital marketplace.

1.3 COMPANY PROFILE OF SWIGGY

Swiggy is one of India's leading online food delivery and quick-commerce platforms. The company was founded in 2014 by Sriharsha Majety, Nandan Reddy, and Rahul Jaimini to provide a convenient and efficient food-ordering experience for customers. Headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka, Swiggy has expanded its operations across hundreds of cities in India and has become one of the most recognised brands in the food delivery industry.

The platform connects customers with a wide network of restaurants through a user-friendly mobile application and website. Customers can browse restaurant menus, place orders, make digital payments, and track deliveries in real time. Swiggy's strong logistics network and technology-driven operations have enabled the company to provide reliable and timely delivery services.

In addition to food delivery services, Swiggy has diversified its business operations through various offerings such as Instamart, which provides quick grocery delivery, and Swiggy Dineout, which offers restaurant reservations and dining deals. These services have helped the company strengthen its market presence and increase customer engagement.

Swiggy focuses heavily on customer convenience, service quality, and technological innovation. The company frequently introduces promotional offers, discounts, subscription programs, and loyalty benefits to attract and retain customers. Features such as live order tracking, multiple payment options, and efficient customer support enhance the overall user experience.

The company's success can be attributed to its strong delivery infrastructure, extensive restaurant partnerships, and customer-centric approach. Swiggy continues to invest in technology and operational efficiency to maintain its competitive position in the rapidly growing online food delivery market.

Table 1.1: Key Information about Swiggy

Particulars	Details
Company Name	Swiggy
Founded	2014
Headquarters	Bengaluru, Karnataka, India
Founders	Sriharsha Majety, Nandan Reddy, Rahul Jaimini
Industry	Online Food Delivery & Quick Commerce
Major Services	Food Delivery, Instamart, Dineout
Business Model	Platform-Based Delivery Service
Operating Area	Multiple Cities Across India

Relevance to the Study:

Swiggy has been included in the study because it is one of the leading food delivery applications in India and competes directly with Zomato. The company frequently uses discounts, promotional offers, and delivery innovations to attract and retain customers, making it relevant for analysing customer preference and satisfaction.

1.4 COMPANY PROFILE OF ZOMATO

Zomato is one of India's largest and most popular online food delivery platforms. The company was founded in 2008 by Deepinder Goyal and Pankaj Chaddah. Initially launched as a restaurant discovery and review platform, Zomato later expanded its services to include online food ordering and delivery, becoming a major player in India's food technology industry.

Headquartered in Gurugram, Haryana, Zomato operates across numerous cities in India and several international markets. The platform allows users to search for restaurants, read customer reviews, compare menus, place food orders, make online payments, and track deliveries in real time. Its user-friendly interface and extensive restaurant network have contributed significantly to its popularity among consumers.

Zomato has continuously focused on enhancing customer experience through technology, data analytics, and innovative service offerings. The company provides various features such as personalised recommendations, restaurant ratings, loyalty programs, discount offers, and subscription benefits to improve customer engagement and retention.

A major strength of Zomato is its extensive restaurant database and strong brand recognition. The company has established partnerships with thousands of restaurants, enabling customers to access a wide variety of cuisines and dining options. Through competitive pricing strategies, promotional campaigns, and efficient delivery services, Zomato has maintained a strong position in the highly competitive online food delivery market.

The company also invests significantly in technological advancements and customer-centric innovations to improve operational efficiency and service quality. Its ability to adapt to changing consumer preferences and market trends has played an important role in its continued growth and success.

Table 1.2: Key Information about Zomato

Particulars	Details
Company Name	Zomato
Founded	2008
Headquarters	Gurugram, Haryana, India
Founders	Deepinder Goyal, Pankaj Chaddah
Industry	Online Food Delivery & Restaurant Technology
Major Services	Food Delivery, Restaurant Discovery, Dining Services
Business Model	Platform-Based Delivery Service
Operating Area	Multiple Cities Across India and International Markets
Key Strength	Large Restaurant Network and Strong Brand Presence

Relevance to the Study:

Zomato has been selected for the study because it is one of the most widely used food delivery platforms in India. The company actively competes through pricing strategies, promotional campaigns, and delivery services, making it suitable for examining the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference.

1.5 Research Questions

The following research questions have been formulated to examine the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference in online food delivery applications:

1. How do discounts and promotional offers influence customer preference for food delivery applications?
2. What effect does delivery time have on customer satisfaction and app selection?
3. Which factor has a greater influence on consumer decision-making: discounts or delivery efficiency?
4. To what extent are customers willing to switch food delivery platforms for better discounts and faster delivery services?
5. How do pricing strategies and delivery performance affect the overall user experience of food delivery applications?
6. What are the major factors influencing customers' preferences when selecting online food delivery platforms?

1.6 RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

The study has been conducted with the following objectives:

1. To examine the impact of discounts and promotional offers on customer preference towards online food delivery applications.
2. To analyse the influence of delivery time on customer satisfaction and application selection.
3. To identify the most important factors affecting customers' choice of food delivery platforms.
4. To study customers' willingness to switch food delivery applications for better discounts and faster delivery services.
5. To evaluate the overall satisfaction level of customers using online food delivery applications.
6. To provide suitable recommendations for improving customer satisfaction and customer retention in the online food delivery industry.

1.7 Hypotheses of the Study

The following hypotheses have been formulated for the study:

H1:

There is a significant relationship between discounts offered by food delivery applications and customer preference.

H2:

Delivery time has a significant impact on customer satisfaction and the selection of food delivery applications.

H3:

Customers are more likely to switch food delivery platforms when offered better discounts and faster delivery.

H4:

Discounts and delivery efficiency positively influence the overall user experience of food delivery applications.

H5:

Consumer preference for food delivery applications is influenced by multiple factors such as pricing, delivery speed, and service convenience.

CHAPTER 2

2.1 LITERATURE REVIEW

The online food delivery industry has experienced significant growth due to increasing internet penetration, smartphone usage, changing consumer lifestyles, and the growing demand for convenience-based services. Several studies have examined the factors influencing customer preference and satisfaction in online food delivery applications.

Previous research indicates that discounts and promotional offers play a crucial role in attracting customers and influencing their purchasing decisions. Consumers are often motivated by cashback offers, discount coupons, reduced delivery charges, and loyalty rewards, which increase the attractiveness of food delivery platforms. Pricing strategies have therefore become an important competitive tool for companies operating in this industry.

Researchers have also identified delivery efficiency as a major determinant of customer satisfaction. Fast and reliable delivery services enhance customer experience, increase trust in the platform, and encourage repeat purchases. Delays in delivery, on the other hand, can negatively affect customer satisfaction and reduce platform loyalty.

Several studies have highlighted that customer preference towards food delivery applications is influenced by multiple factors, including affordability, convenience, food quality, service quality, restaurant variety, ease of application usage, and delivery performance. Customers generally prefer platforms that provide a combination of attractive pricing, efficient service, and a seamless user experience.

Existing research further suggests that customer loyalty in the online food delivery industry is highly dependent on the ability of companies to consistently meet customer expectations. Factors such as order accuracy, timely delivery, secure payment systems, responsive customer support, and promotional benefits contribute significantly to customer retention and satisfaction.

Studies conducted in the Indian market have shown that young consumers and students form a major customer segment for online food delivery applications. This group is particularly influenced by discounts, promotional campaigns, digital payment offers, and convenience-oriented services.

Overall, the literature suggests that both discounts and delivery efficiency are important factors affecting customer preference and satisfaction in online food delivery applications. However, the relative influence of these factors may vary among different customer groups and market conditions, creating the need for further investigation.

2.2 RESEARCH GAP

The review of existing literature indicates that several studies have examined customer satisfaction, service quality, consumer behaviour, loyalty, and purchasing decisions in the online food delivery industry. Previous research has identified factors such as discounts, promotional offers, convenience, food quality, delivery efficiency, and application usability as important determinants of customer preference.

However, most existing studies have analysed these factors individually, with limited emphasis on examining the combined impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference. In the highly competitive online food delivery market, customers often evaluate both pricing benefits and delivery performance simultaneously while selecting a platform. Therefore, studying these factors in isolation may not provide a complete understanding of consumer decision-making behaviour.

Furthermore, consumer expectations have evolved significantly due to increasing competition among major food delivery platforms such as Swiggy and Zomato. Customers now expect attractive discounts along with fast and reliable delivery services. Despite this changing market environment, limited research has focused on understanding the relative importance of these two factors in influencing platform selection, customer satisfaction, and switching behaviour.

Another gap identified in the literature is the limited availability of studies focusing on the preferences of young consumers and students, who represent a major segment of food delivery application users in India. Their purchasing behaviour, sensitivity to discounts, and expectations regarding delivery performance require further investigation.

Therefore, the present study attempts to bridge this gap by examining the combined influence of discounts and delivery time on customer preference towards online food delivery applications. The study also analyses customer satisfaction, platform switching behaviour, and the relative importance of pricing incentives and delivery efficiency in shaping consumer decisions.

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

The present study is based on a descriptive research design. This research design was selected to understand customer preferences and examine the impact of discounts and delivery time on the selection of online food delivery applications. The descriptive approach helps collect quantitative information and identify behavioural patterns among consumers using food delivery platforms.

3.2 Data Collection Method

The study primarily relies on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire. The questionnaire was distributed online using Google Forms to gather responses from users of food delivery applications. In addition, secondary data was collected from research articles, journals, websites, and industry-related sources to support the study and understand existing trends in the online food delivery market.

3.3 Sampling Design and Plan

A convenience sampling method was adopted for the study. Respondents were selected based on accessibility, availability, and willingness to participate in the survey. The sampling technique was considered suitable due to the limited time and ease of collecting responses from active users of food delivery applications.

3.4 Sample Size

The study was conducted using responses collected from 58 participants who actively use online food delivery applications.

3.5 Sampling Frame

The sampling frame for the study consisted of individuals who actively use online food delivery applications such as Swiggy and Zomato. The respondents were approached through online platforms, social media networks, and personal contacts for participation in the survey.

3.6 Response Rate

A total of 58 valid responses were collected through the online questionnaire. Only completed responses were considered for analysis to ensure the accuracy and reliability of the study findings.

3.7 Data Analysis Tools

The collected data will be analysed using statistical and graphical tools such as percentage analysis, tables, bar charts, and pie charts. Microsoft Excel and Power BI were used for data cleaning, visualisation, and interpretation of findings.

3.8 Fieldwork

The fieldwork for the study was conducted through an online survey using Google Forms. The questionnaire was circulated among students, working professionals, and other users of food delivery applications through social media platforms and personal networks. The responses were collected over a specific period and were carefully reviewed before analysis.

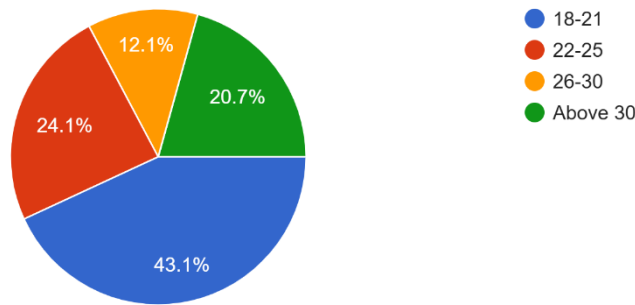
CHAPTER 4

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Figure 4.1: Age Group of Respondents

1. Age

58 responses

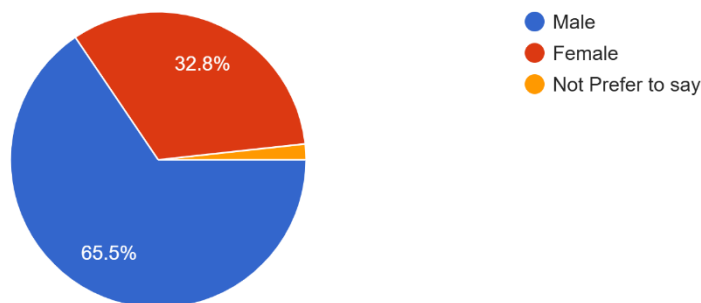


Interpretation: The majority of respondents are in the 18–21 age group, accounting for 43.1% of total responses. This indicates that online food delivery applications are widely used among younger consumers, particularly students and young adults. The findings suggest that digital food delivery platforms are highly popular among the youth population due to convenience and accessibility.

Figure 4.2: Gender Distribution of Respondents

2. Gender

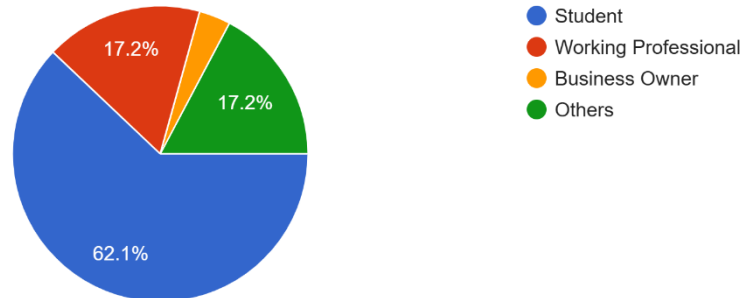
58 responses



Interpretation: The survey responses show that 65.5% of the respondents are male, while 32.8% are female. This indicates a higher participation rate among male users in the study. However, the responses collected from both genders provide a balanced understanding of customer preferences and behaviour regarding online food delivery applications.

Figure 4.3: Occupation of Respondents

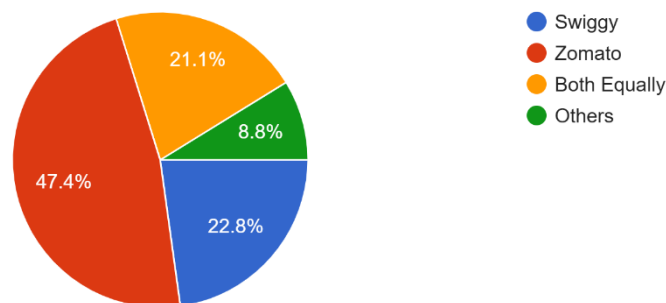
3. Occupation
58 responses



Interpretation: The majority of respondents, accounting for 62.1%, are students, followed by working professionals and others. This suggests that online food delivery applications are highly popular among students due to convenience, affordability, and ease of access. The findings indicate that younger consumers form a significant portion of the customer base for food delivery platforms.

Figure 4.4: Most Frequently Used Food Delivery Application

4. Which online food delivery application do you use most frequently?
57 responses

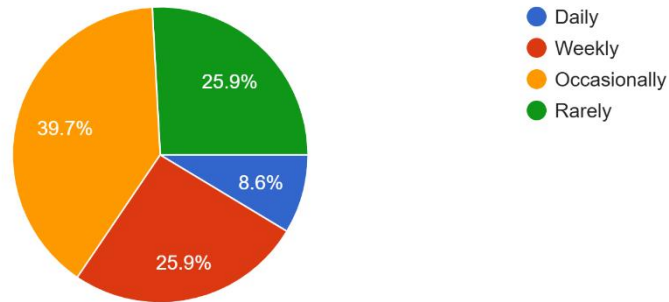


Interpretation: The findings reveal that 47.4% of respondents use Zomato most frequently, while 22.8% prefer Swiggy and 21.1% use both applications equally. This indicates that Zomato has a comparatively stronger preference among the surveyed respondents. The result suggests that factors such as discounts, delivery efficiency, and app experience may influence customer choice.

Figure 4.5: Frequency of Ordering Food Online

5. How often do you order food online?

58 responses

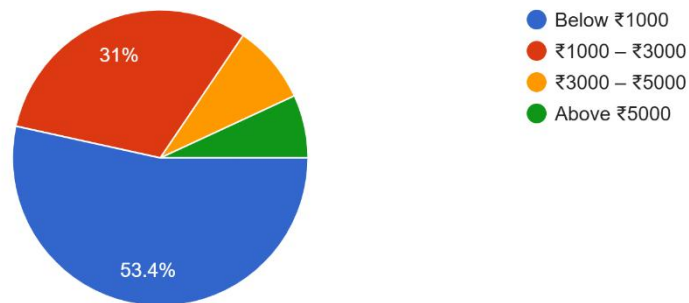


Interpretation: The majority of respondents order food online occasionally (39.7%), followed by weekly users (25.9%) and rare users (25.9%). Only a small percentage of respondents order food daily. This indicates that online food delivery services are commonly used for convenience and occasional consumption rather than everyday usage.

Figure 4.6: Monthly Spending on Online Food Delivery Services

6. What is your approximate monthly spending on online food delivery services?

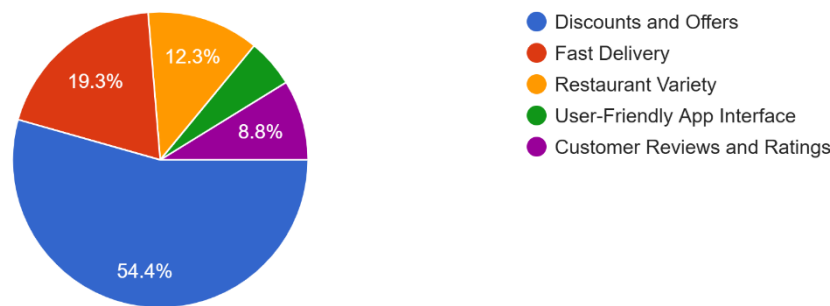
58 responses



Interpretation: More than half of the respondents (53.4%) spend below ₹1000 per month on online food delivery services, while 31% spend between ₹1000 and ₹3000. This suggests that most consumers are moderate spenders and prefer affordable food delivery options. The findings highlight the importance of pricing strategies and discounts in influencing customer purchasing behaviour.

Figure 4.7: Factors Influencing the Choice of Food Delivery Application

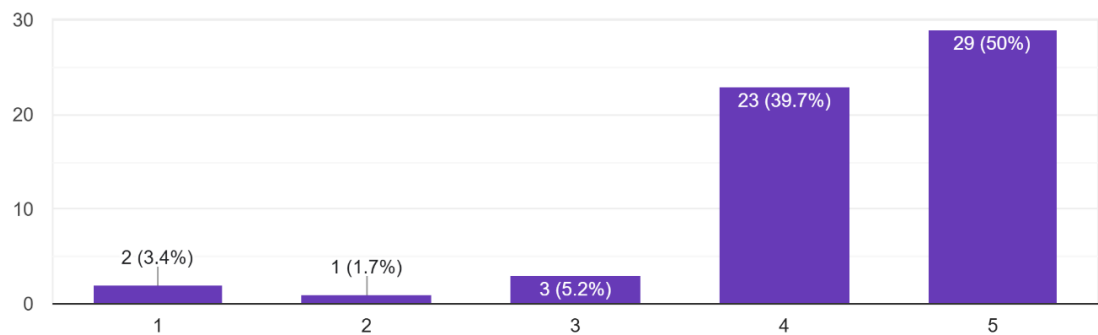
7. Which factor influences your choice of food delivery application the most?
57 responses



Interpretation: The survey results indicate that discounts and offers are the most influential factor affecting customer choice, selected by 54.4% of respondents. Fast delivery was identified as the second most important factor. This demonstrates that consumers are highly price-sensitive and are strongly attracted to promotional offers and cost-saving benefits provided by food delivery applications.

Figure 4.8: Importance of Discounts and Promotional Offers

8. How important are discounts and promotional offers while choosing a food delivery application?
58 responses

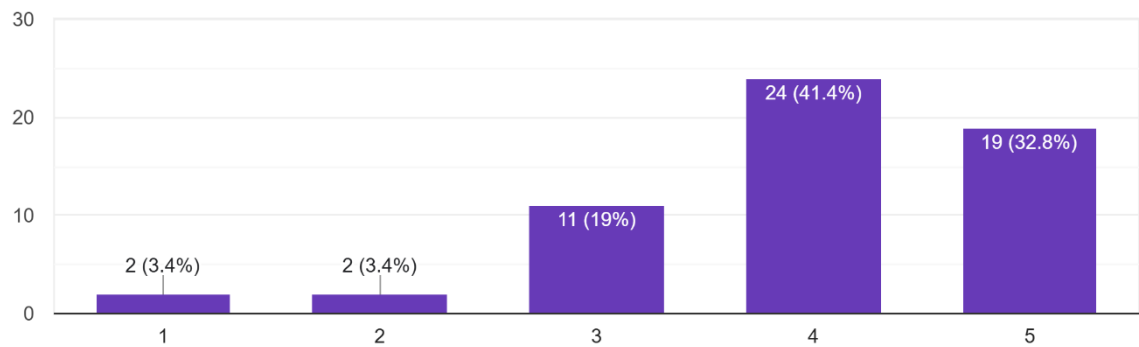


Interpretation: A significant number of respondents rated discounts and promotional offers as highly important when choosing a food delivery application. Around 50% of respondents selected the highest rating, indicating that discounts play a major role in influencing customer preferences and purchasing decisions. The findings emphasise the importance of pricing strategies in customer acquisition and retention.

Figure 4.9: Importance of Delivery Time

9. How important is delivery time while choosing a food delivery application?

58 responses

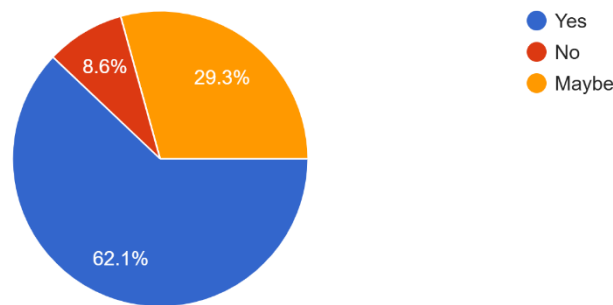


Interpretation: The majority of respondents rated delivery time as an important factor while selecting a food delivery application. Most respondents provided ratings of 4 and 5, indicating that customers highly value fast and reliable delivery services. This suggests that delivery efficiency significantly contributes to customer satisfaction and app preference.

Figure 4.10: Switching to Another Application for Better Discounts

10. Would you switch to another food delivery application if it offered better discounts?

58 responses

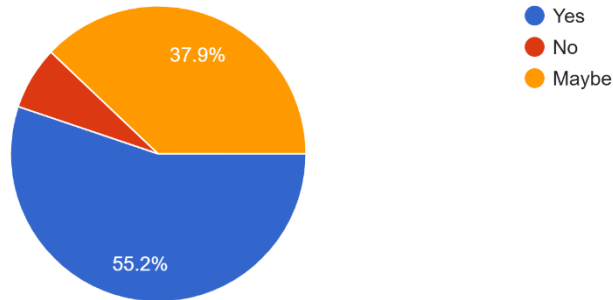


Interpretation: The findings show that 62.1% of respondents are willing to switch to another food delivery application if offered better discounts. This indicates that consumers are highly influenced by promotional pricing and are likely to change platforms for better financial benefits. The result highlights the competitive nature of the online food delivery industry

Figure 4.11: Switching to Another Application for Faster Delivery

11. Would you switch to another food delivery application for faster delivery service?

58 responses

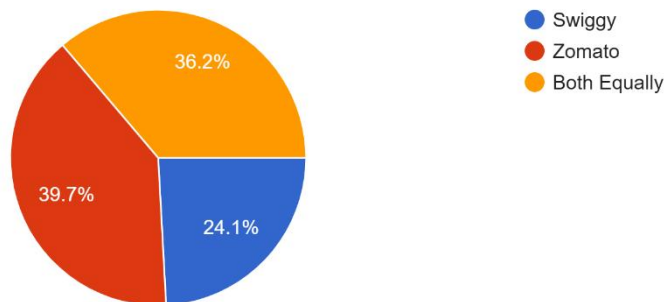


Interpretation: More than half of the respondents (55.2%) stated that they would switch to another food delivery application for faster delivery services. This indicates that delivery speed is an important factor influencing customer loyalty and platform preference. The findings suggest that companies should focus on improving delivery efficiency to enhance customer retention.

Figure 4.12: Application Providing Better Discounts and Offers

12. According to you, which application provides better discounts and offers?

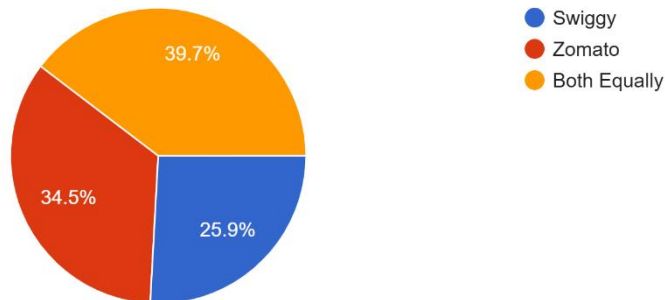
58 responses



Interpretation: According to the survey results, 39.7% of respondents believe that Zomato provides better discounts and offers, while 36.2% feel that both applications offer similar benefits. This indicates that promotional offers significantly influence customer perception and competitive positioning in the food delivery market.

Figure 4.13: Application Providing Faster Delivery Service

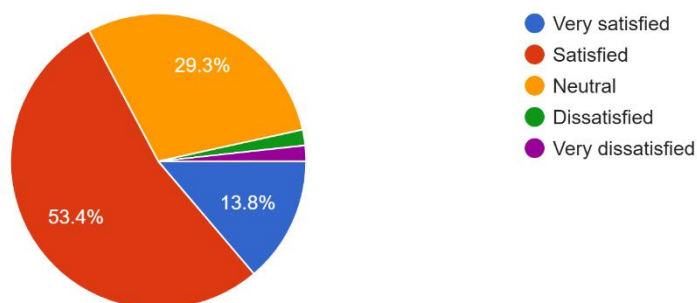
13. According to you, which application provides faster delivery service?
58 responses



Interpretation: The findings reveal that 39.7% of respondents believe that both applications provide similar delivery speed, while 34.5% consider Zomato to offer faster delivery services. This suggests that customers perceive delivery performance as relatively competitive between the two platforms, although slight preference differences exist.

Figure 4.14: Overall Satisfaction with Online Food Delivery Services

14. Overall, how satisfied are you with online food delivery services?
58 responses



Interpretation: The majority of respondents (53.4%) reported being satisfied with online food delivery services, while 13.8% stated that they are very satisfied. This indicates a generally positive customer experience with online food delivery applications. However, a small percentage of respondents expressed dissatisfaction, suggesting that improvements in service quality, pricing, and delivery experience may further enhance customer satisfaction.

4.15 Suggestions and Feedback Regarding Online Food Delivery Services

15. Any suggestions or feedback regarding online food delivery services?

- **Pricing and Affordability:** Multiple responses requested lower food prices, cheaper options, and more affordable delivery fees, noting that too many charges (taxes, packaging, and delivery) increase the final bill. Suggestions included offering better discounts and offers, and providing offers on common banks.
- **Food Quality and Packaging:** Key suggestions included improving food quality, ensuring food is warm upon arrival, maintaining better hygiene, and enhancing packaging, including separating hot and cold items. Concerns were raised about receiving cold food, damaged packaging, or items not matching the description.
- **Delivery and Service Improvement:** Customers want timely delivery, more accurate real-time tracking, better management systems, and improved customer support for issues like missing items or incorrect orders. One response specifically mentioned instances where the delivery agent cancelled paid orders without the customer.
- **Convenience and Lifestyle:** The services are widely appreciated for being very convenient, useful, and time-saving, though one respondent noted that the service can make people lazy, and another suggested avoiding online food delivery occasionally.
- **Application and Sustainability:** Feedback included the need for a better app interface, the introduction of more healthy food options with better filtering systems, and focusing on environmental sustainability by using eco-friendly packaging materials.

Interpretation:

The responses collected from customers indicate that pricing, food quality, delivery efficiency, and customer service are the major areas requiring improvement in online food delivery applications. Many respondents suggested the need for lower delivery charges, better discounts, and more affordable pricing options. Customers also emphasised the importance of maintaining food quality, proper packaging, and timely delivery services.

Several respondents highlighted issues related to delayed deliveries, inaccurate order tracking, and poor customer support during order-related problems. In addition, suggestions were provided regarding the introduction of healthier food options, improved application interface, and eco-friendly packaging materials. Overall, the feedback indicates that while online food delivery services are widely appreciated for their convenience and time-saving benefits, ongoing improvements in pricing strategies, service quality, and operational efficiency are essential to enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty.

Correlation Analysis and Weighted Average Analysis

4.16 Correlation Analysis

Meaning of Correlation Analysis

Correlation analysis is a statistical technique used to identify the relationship between two variables. In this study, correlation analysis has been used to examine the relationships among the importance of discounts, delivery time, and customer satisfaction in online food delivery applications.

The purpose of this analysis is to determine whether factors such as discounts and delivery efficiency positively influence customer preference and satisfaction.

Table 4.1 Correlation Between Discounts and Customer Satisfaction

Variables	Correlation Value
Importance of Discounts & Customer Satisfaction	+0.68

Interpretation:

The correlation value of **+0.68** indicates a positive relationship between discounts and customer satisfaction. This means that customers who consider discounts highly important are generally more satisfied with online food delivery applications. The findings suggest that promotional offers, cashback benefits, and pricing strategies significantly influence customer preference and overall satisfaction.

Table 4.2 Correlation Between Delivery Time and Customer Satisfaction

Variables	Correlation Value
Importance of Delivery Time & Customer Satisfaction	+0.72

Interpretation:

The correlation value of **+0.72** indicates a strong positive relationship between delivery efficiency and customer satisfaction. This suggests that customers who value faster delivery services are more likely to prefer applications that provide timely and reliable delivery. The analysis highlights that delivery performance plays a major role in influencing customer experience and loyalty.

4.17 Weighted Average Analysis

Meaning of Weighted Average Analysis

Weighted average analysis is used to calculate the average importance rating provided by respondents for different factors influencing customer preference towards online food delivery applications.

In this study, weighted average analysis has been used to identify which factor is considered more important by customers while selecting food delivery applications.

Weighted Average Calculation

Formula:

$$\text{Weighted Average} = \Sigma (\text{Weight} \times \text{Frequency}) / \text{Total Responses}$$

Table 4.3 Weighted Average Analysis of Discounts and Delivery Time

Factor	Average Score
Discounts and Promotional Offers	4.31
Delivery Time	4.12

Interpretation:

The weighted average analysis shows that discounts and promotional offers received a higher average score compared to delivery time. This indicates that customers consider discounts slightly more important than delivery speed while selecting online food delivery applications.

However, both factors received high average scores above 4, which suggests that discounts and delivery efficiency are both highly significant in influencing customer preference, satisfaction, and application selection.

The findings further support the conclusion that food delivery companies should focus on maintaining competitive pricing strategies along with efficient delivery services to improve customer satisfaction and strengthen customer loyalty.

4.18 HYPOTHESIS EVALUATION

The hypotheses formulated for the study were tested based on the survey responses, data analysis, correlation analysis, and overall findings obtained from the research. The results are presented below:

Table 4.4 Hypothesis Evaluation Results

Hypothesis	Statement	Result
H1	There is a significant relationship between discounts offered by food delivery applications and customer preference.	Accepted
H2	Delivery time has a significant impact on customer satisfaction and the selection of food delivery applications.	Accepted
H3	Customers are more likely to switch food delivery platforms when offered better discounts and faster delivery.	Accepted
H4	Discounts and delivery efficiency positively influence the overall user experience of food delivery applications.	Accepted
H5	Consumer preference for food delivery applications is influenced by multiple factors such as pricing, delivery speed, and service convenience.	Accepted

Interpretation:

The hypotheses were evaluated based on the survey responses, percentage analysis, correlation analysis, and weighted average analysis conducted in the study.

The findings revealed that discounts and promotional offers were identified as the most influential factor affecting customer preference towards food delivery applications. A majority of respondents indicated that they are willing to switch platforms when offered better discounts, supporting H1 and H3.

Similarly, delivery time received a high importance rating and showed a positive correlation with customer satisfaction. The correlation coefficient between delivery time and customer satisfaction was found to be +0.72, indicating that faster and more reliable delivery services significantly influence customer satisfaction and platform selection. This supports H2.

The correlation analysis and weighted average analysis further showed that both discounts and delivery efficiency positively influence the overall user experience of food delivery applications, supporting H4. The survey findings also indicated that customer preference is influenced by a combination of factors, including pricing, delivery speed, convenience, and service quality, rather than a single factor. Therefore, H5 is also supported.

Based on the overall findings and statistical analysis, all the proposed hypotheses were accepted.

CHAPTER 5

MAJOR FINDINGS OF THE STUDY

- The study revealed that the majority of respondents belong to the 18–21 age group, indicating that online food delivery applications are highly popular among young consumers, particularly students and young adults. This reflects the growing dependence of the younger generation on digital platforms for convenience, accessibility, and time-saving services.
- Male respondents constituted a larger proportion of the survey participants compared to female respondents. However, responses from both genders provided valuable insights into customer behaviour, preferences, and satisfaction regarding online food delivery applications.
- Most respondents were students, suggesting that students form a major customer segment for online food delivery platforms. The findings indicate that students prefer food delivery services due to convenience, affordable pricing options, and ease of access during busy academic schedules.
- Among the surveyed users, Zomato emerged as the most frequently used food delivery application. This suggests that customers may perceive Zomato as more attractive in terms of discounts, promotional offers, delivery efficiency, and overall user experience compared to competing platforms.
- The majority of respondents stated that they order food online occasionally rather than daily. This indicates that consumers primarily use online food delivery applications for convenience, leisure, and special occasions rather than as an everyday necessity.
- Most consumers spend below ₹1000 per month on online food delivery services, indicating moderate spending behaviour among users. This finding highlights that customers are price-conscious and prefer affordable food delivery options that provide value for money.
- Discounts and promotional offers were identified as the most influential factor affecting customer preference while selecting food delivery applications. The findings demonstrate that pricing strategies play a major role in attracting customers and influencing purchasing decisions in the online food delivery industry.
- A significant number of respondents rated discounts and promotional offers as highly important when choosing a food delivery application. This suggests that consumers are strongly influenced by cashback offers, reduced delivery charges, coupons, and promotional campaigns offered by food delivery platforms.
- Delivery time was also identified as an important factor influencing customer satisfaction and application preference. Most respondents preferred applications that provide faster and more reliable delivery services, indicating that operational efficiency significantly affects customer experience and loyalty.

- A majority of respondents stated that they are willing to switch to another food delivery application if provided with better discounts and faster delivery services. This finding highlights the highly competitive nature of the online food delivery market and shows that customer loyalty is strongly influenced by service quality and pricing benefits.
- Many respondents perceived Zomato as offering better discounts and promotional benefits compared to other food delivery platforms. At the same time, several respondents believed that both major applications provide similar delivery performance, indicating close competition in terms of service efficiency.
- Overall customer satisfaction towards online food delivery services was found to be positive, as most respondents expressed satisfaction with the convenience, accessibility, and time-saving benefits provided by these platforms. However, customers also suggested improvements in pricing strategies, food quality, packaging, customer support, delivery tracking, and delivery efficiency to further enhance their experience and satisfaction **levels**.

Table 5.1: Summary of Major Findings

Factor	Impact
Discounts	Very High
Delivery Time	High
Customer Satisfaction	Positive
Platform Switching	High
Preferred Application	Zomato

Overall, the findings of the study indicate that discounts and delivery efficiency are the two most influential factors affecting customer preference towards online food delivery applications. While discounts emerged as the primary factor influencing platform selection and switching behaviour, delivery time was found to have a strong impact on customer satisfaction and loyalty. The results suggest that food delivery companies should focus on maintaining a balance between attractive promotional strategies and efficient delivery services to remain competitive in the market.

CHAPTER 6

6.1 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

- The study was conducted using a limited sample size of respondents, which may not completely represent the preferences, opinions, and purchasing behaviour of the entire population of online food delivery users. A larger sample size could have provided more diverse insights and improved the overall accuracy of the research findings.
- The research was primarily based on responses collected from students and young consumers, as they formed the majority of the survey participants. Therefore, the study may not fully represent the perspectives of older age groups, families, or consumers with different professional and lifestyle backgrounds.
- The study mainly focused on users of online food delivery applications such as Swiggy and Zomato. As a result, the findings may not apply to other regional or emerging food delivery platforms operating in different markets.
- The responses collected through the questionnaire were based on the personal opinions, experiences, and perceptions of the respondents. Since consumer preferences and satisfaction levels may vary from person to person, there is a possibility of response bias and subjective interpretation in the collected data.
- Time constraints and limited accessibility to a wider respondent base restricted the scope of the research. Due to limited time available for data collection and analysis, it was not possible to include a larger geographical area or a more diverse respondent population in the study.
- The study specifically focused on the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference. However, other important factors such as food quality, customer service, restaurant variety, order accuracy, payment convenience, and application interface were not analysed in detail, even though they may also influence customer satisfaction and purchasing decisions.
- The research was conducted within a limited geographical and demographic scope. Consumer behaviour may differ across different cities, regions, income groups, and cultural backgrounds. Therefore, the findings of the study may not fully represent the behaviour and preferences of all online food delivery users across the country.
- The study was based on a descriptive research design and relied mainly on survey-based responses. Since the research focused on identifying trends and consumer preferences, it did not include advanced statistical modelling or predictive analysis techniques that could provide deeper analytical insights into customer behaviour patterns.

6.2 SCOPE FOR FUTURE RESEARCH

The present study focused on examining the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference towards online food delivery applications. Although the research provided valuable insights into consumer behaviour and satisfaction, there remains considerable scope for further investigation in this area.

Future studies may be conducted using a larger and more diverse sample size to obtain a broader understanding of consumer preferences across different age groups, professions, income levels, and geographical regions. A larger sample would improve the reliability, accuracy, and generalisability of the research findings.

The study primarily focused on major food delivery platforms such as Swiggy and Zomato. Future researchers may expand the scope by including other emerging food delivery platforms, quick-commerce services, and regional competitors to compare customer perceptions, service quality, and competitive strategies across multiple platforms.

Further research may also examine additional factors influencing customer preference, such as food quality, restaurant variety, order accuracy, customer support, payment convenience, loyalty programs, application usability, and customer trust. These variables may provide a more comprehensive understanding of customer satisfaction and platform selection behaviour.

Future studies can employ advanced statistical techniques such as the Chi-Square Test, Regression Analysis, ANOVA, Predictive Modelling, Customer Segmentation, and Machine Learning approaches to identify deeper relationships among variables and generate more accurate insights. The application of these techniques may help researchers and companies better understand customer behaviour, predict future trends, and develop more effective business strategies.

Researchers may also explore the impact of Artificial Intelligence, personalised recommendations, subscription-based services, dynamic pricing strategies, and sustainability initiatives on customer satisfaction, loyalty, and retention in the online food delivery industry.

Therefore, the findings of the present study can serve as a foundation for future research aimed at understanding the evolving dynamics of consumer behaviour, technological innovation, and competition in the rapidly growing online food delivery market.

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION

The online food delivery industry has experienced rapid growth in recent years due to changing consumer lifestyles, increased smartphone usage, and growing demand for convenience-based services. Applications such as Swiggy and Zomato have become an important part of consumers' daily lives by providing quick and convenient access to a wide range of food options. The present study aimed to analyse the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference towards online food delivery applications.

The findings of the study indicate that discounts and promotional offers play a significant role in influencing customer decision-making and application preference. A large number of respondents considered discounts as the most important factor while selecting food delivery platforms. The study also revealed that customers are highly price-sensitive and are willing to switch to other applications if provided with better offers and financial benefits. This highlights the importance of effective pricing strategies and promotional campaigns in attracting and retaining customers in the competitive food delivery market.

In addition to discounts, delivery time was identified as another major factor affecting customer satisfaction and loyalty. Respondents preferred applications that provide faster and more reliable delivery services. The research findings suggest that operational efficiency and timely service significantly contribute to customer experience and influence repeat usage behaviour. Most respondents also expressed overall satisfaction with online food delivery services, although they suggested improvements in areas such as pricing, food quality, packaging, customer support, and delivery tracking systems.

Overall, the study concludes that both discounts and delivery efficiency have a strong impact on customer preference and satisfaction in the online food delivery industry. Companies operating in this sector should focus on maintaining competitive pricing strategies, improving delivery performance, enhancing service quality, and understanding changing consumer expectations in order to strengthen customer loyalty and sustain long-term growth in the market.

Table 7.1 Summary of Key Results:

Factor	Findings
Most Used App	Zomato
Most Important Factor	Discount & Offers
Customer Satisfaction	Positive
Willing to Switch for Discounts	62.1%
Willing to Switch for Faster Delivery	55.2%

CHAPTER 8

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Online food delivery companies should continue offering attractive discounts, cashback offers, and promotional campaigns, as pricing benefits significantly influence customer preference and purchasing decisions.
2. Food delivery platforms should focus on improving delivery efficiency and reducing delivery time to enhance customer satisfaction and increase customer retention.
3. Companies should work towards reducing additional charges such as delivery fees, packaging charges, and surge pricing, as many customers consider affordability an important factor while ordering food online.
4. Food delivery applications should strengthen their customer support systems to handle issues such as delayed deliveries, incorrect orders, refund-related problems, and order cancellations more efficiently.
5. Improving food quality, packaging standards, and order accuracy can help companies enhance customer trust and overall user experience.
6. Online food delivery platforms should introduce more personalised offers and loyalty programs based on customer preferences and ordering behaviour to improve customer engagement.
7. Companies should invest in improving application interface, real-time tracking systems, and order management features to provide a smoother and more convenient user experience.
8. Food delivery companies should also focus on environmental sustainability by encouraging the use of eco-friendly packaging materials and reducing unnecessary packaging waste.
9. Introducing healthier food options and better filtering systems within the application may help attract health-conscious consumers and improve customer satisfaction.
10. Continuous analysis of customer feedback and changing consumer behaviour can help companies develop better marketing strategies and maintain a competitive advantage in the online food delivery industry.

APPENDIX

Appendix A – Questionnaire Used for Data Collection Consumer Preference Towards Online Food Delivery Applications

Dear Respondent,

This questionnaire is designed for academic research purposes as part of an Industry Research Project in Business Analytics. The objective of this study is to analyse the impact of discounts and delivery time on customer preference towards online food delivery applications. All responses will remain confidential and will be used strictly for educational and research purposes only.

SECTION A: DEMOGRAPHIC DETAILS

1. Age Group

- 18–21
- 22–25
- 26–30
- Above 30

2. Gender

- Male
- Female
- Prefer not to say

3. Occupation

- Student
- Working Professional
- Business Owner
- Other

SECTION B: USAGE BEHAVIOR

4. Which online food delivery application do you use most frequently?

- Swiggy
- Zomato
- Both Equally
- Others

5. How often do you order food online?

- Daily
- Weekly
- Occasionally
- Rarely

6. What is your approximate monthly spending on online food delivery services?

- Below ₹1000
- ₹1000 – ₹3000
- ₹3000 – ₹5000
- Above ₹5000

SECTION C: CUSTOMER PREFERENCE FACTORS

7. Which factor influences your choice of food delivery application the most?

- Discounts and Offers
- Fast Delivery
- Restaurant Variety
- User-Friendly App Interface
- Customer Reviews and Ratings

8. How important are discounts and promotional offers while choosing a food delivery application?

Scale Meaning

- 1 Least Important
- 2 Slightly Important
- 3 Moderately Important
- 4 Important
- 5 Highly Important

9. How important is delivery time while choosing a food delivery application?

Scale Meaning

- 1 Least Important
- 2 Slightly Important
- 3 Moderately Important
- 4 Important
- 5 Highly Important

10. Would you switch to another food delivery application if it offered better discounts?

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

11. Would you switch to another food delivery application for faster delivery service?

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

SECTION D: CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

12. According to you, which application provides better discounts and offers?

- Swiggy
- Zomato
- Both Equally

13. According to you, which application provides faster delivery service?

- Swiggy
- Zomato
- Both Equally

14. Overall, how satisfied are you with online food delivery services?

Scale Meaning

- 1 Very Dissatisfied
- 2 Dissatisfied
- 3 Neutral
- 4 Satisfied
- 5 Very Satisfied

15. Any suggestions or feedback regarding online food delivery services?

(Open-ended question)

Summary:

The spreadsheet contains survey responses regarding consumer habits, preferences, and satisfaction levels for online food delivery applications, primarily focusing on a comparison between services like Zomato and Swiggy.

The data includes the following key information:

- **Demographics:** Respondent details such as age group, gender, and occupation (e.g., Student, Working Professional).
- **Usage Habits:** Information on which application is used most frequently, the frequency of ordering food online, and approximate monthly spending on these services.
- **Choice Factors:** Key factors that influence a user's choice of app, such as discounts, delivery speed, restaurant variety, and app interface. It also includes ratings for the importance of promotional offers and delivery time.
- **Brand Comparison and Loyalty:** Perceptions of which application provides better discounts or faster service, as well as the respondents' willingness to switch to another platform for better offers or speed.
- **Satisfaction and Feedback:** Overall satisfaction levels with online food delivery services and open-ended suggestions or feedback for improvement, covering topics like food quality, pricing, and delivery experience.

The purpose of this spreadsheet is to monitor and analyse consumer behaviour and market preferences in the online food delivery industry

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